My Generous Fattoush

FROM NELL'S KITCHEN

I like my fattoush full of colour, texture and fresh herbs, with something different in every bite.

Serves 6–8 · Prep 25 min

INGREDIENTS

FOR THE FATTOUSH

- 3 spring onions, thinly sliced into rounds
- 2 tbsp olive oil, for resting the spring onions
- 1 medium romaine lettuce, chopped
- 75 g rocket leaves, cut crosswise into roughly three sections
- 1 generous bunch flat-leaf parsley, leaves picked and kept whole
- 1 generous handful of purslane, leaves picked
- A small handful of fresh za'atar leaves, using the variety with long, narrow leaves
- 3 large ripe, aromatic tomatoes, cut into large cubes
- 3 Lebanese cucumbers, thinly sliced into rounds
- 6 radishes, thinly sliced into rounds
- 1 green bell pepper, deseeded and cut into medium dice

FOR THE DRESSING

- 4 tbsp extra-virgin olive oil
- 2 tbsp balsamic vinegar
- 2 tbsp pomegranate molasses
- 1 tbsp sumac
- 1 tbsp fresh lemon juice, adjusted to taste
- Salt, to taste

FOR THE CRISPY BREAD

- 2 medium Lebanese flatbreads, cut into bite-sized pieces
- Vegetable oil, for frying

METHOD

1. Place the sliced spring onions in a small bowl with two tablespoons of olive oil. Toss well, cover and refrigerate for at least 2 hours to mellow their intensity.
2. Wash the lettuce, rocket, parsley, purslane and fresh za'atar, then dry thoroughly. Keep the parsley leaves whole and cut the rocket crosswise into roughly three sections.
3. Prepare the tomatoes, cucumbers, radishes and green pepper, keeping the cucumber and radish slices thin.
4. Heat the frying oil in a deep frying pan. Fry the bread in small batches until golden and crisp, watching closely as it colours quickly. Lift out with a slotted spoon and drain on kitchen paper. Allow to cool.
5. Whisk together the dressing ingredients. Taste and adjust the salt and lemon juice, keeping a balance between the sweetness of the molasses and the acidity of the vinegar and lemon.
6. Just before serving, place the lettuce, rocket, parsley, purslane, fresh za'atar, tomatoes, cucumbers, radishes and green pepper in a large bowl.
7. Add the spring onions together with their olive oil. Pour over the dressing gradually and toss gently until everything is evenly coated, using as much dressing as needed.
8. Arrange on a wide serving platter. Place the crispy fried bread around the borders, keeping it separate from the dressed vegetables. Serve immediately.

Tip

Choose fragrant, ripe tomatoes. Their flavour makes a real difference, especially when served in generous pieces.